

Part A: Parts of Speech

Identify the part of speech of the **bolded** word: *noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, or conjunction.*

1. The **lantern** swung from a rusted hook. _____
2. Owls **hunt** along the ridge at dusk. _____
3. A **crooked** fence surrounds the orchard. _____
4. Renata folded the map **carefully**. _____
5. The mail sat **under** a stack of catalogs. _____
6. The engine sputtered **but** never died. _____
7. **They** repainted the crosswalk overnight. _____
8. My cousin studies marine **biology**. _____
9. The choir sang **softly** during the vigil. _____
10. Three **rusty** nails lay on the workbench. _____
11. Hail **dented** the hood of the truck. _____
12. Set the ladder **against** the wall. _____
13. The prize belongs to **her**. _____
14. We can hike the loop **or** take the shuttle. _____
15. The train arrived **early** for once. _____
16. Patience is a rare **quality**. _____
17. The kettle **whistled** in the kitchen. _____
18. The **empty** aquarium collected dust. _____
19. A hummingbird hovered **beside** the feeder. _____
20. **Everyone** signed the birthday card. _____

Part B: Subject and Predicate

For each sentence write (a) the complete subject, (b) the complete predicate, (c) the simple subject, and (d) the simple predicate.

21. The nervous violinist tuned her strings.
22. Caleb and his sister repaired the mailbox.
23. Across the field marched a brass band.
24. The faint smell of smoke woke the neighbors.

25. My aunt's antique clock chimes every hour.
26. The patient tutor explained the problem twice.
27. Beneath the stairs lay a dusty toolbox.
28. The pitcher adjusted her cap and threw the ball.
29. The mayor and the council approved the budget.
30. A small, determined terrier chased the mail truck.
31. Inside the envelope was a faded photograph.
32. The retired teacher volunteers at the library.
33. Nadia washed the dishes and swept the porch.
34. The rows of folding chairs filled the gym.

35. My uncle's two acres of vineyard need pruning.

Part C: Subject–Verb Agreement

Circle the correct verb.

36. The bouquet of roses (was / were) delivered this morning.
37. Each of the windows (need / needs) new caulking.
38. Rosa and Tomás (rides / ride) the same bus.
39. Neither the students nor the teacher (want / wants) a quiz.
40. There (was / were) three messages on the machine.
41. The mathematics of the design (confuse / confuses) me.
42. A bundle of newspapers (sit / sits) by the curb.
43. Both of the recipes (call / calls) for buttermilk.
44. Either the manager or the clerks (open / opens) the store.
45. The stains on the ceiling (mark / marks) an old leak.
46. Everybody in the cabins (has / have) a flashlight.
47. Twenty minutes (seem / seems) like a long wait.
48. There (go / goes) the last two ferries.
49. Half of the cake (was / were) gone by noon.
50. Discipline and practice (build / builds) confidence.

Each sentence below has one agreement error. Rewrite it correctly.

51. The crate of oranges were left outside.
52. Neither Owen nor his brothers plays the piano.
53. There is four bicycles in the rack.
54. Each of the volunteers wear a badge.
55. The photographs stored in the box was damaged.

Answer Key

Part A: Parts of Speech

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|----------------|-----------------|
| 1. noun | 11. verb |
| 2. verb | 12. preposition |
| 3. adjective | 13. pronoun |
| 4. adverb | 14. conjunction |
| 5. preposition | 15. adverb |
| 6. conjunction | 16. noun |
| 7. pronoun | 17. verb |
| 8. noun | 18. adjective |
| 9. adverb | 19. preposition |
| 10. adjective | 20. pronoun |

Part B: Subject and Predicate

CS = complete subject, CP = complete predicate, SS = simple subject, SP = simple predicate.

21. CS: The nervous violinist CP: tuned her strings SS: violinist SP: tuned
22. CS: Caleb and his sister CP: repaired the mailbox SS: Caleb, sister (compound) SP: repaired
23. CS: a brass band CP: Across the field marched SS: band SP: marched (inverted order)
24. CS: The faint smell of smoke CP: woke the neighbors SS: smell SP: woke
25. CS: My aunt's antique clock CP: chimes every hour SS: clock SP: chimes
26. CS: The patient tutor CP: explained the problem twice SS: tutor SP: explained
27. CS: a dusty toolbox CP: Beneath the stairs lay SS: toolbox SP: lay (inverted order)
28. CS: The pitcher CP: adjusted her cap and threw the ball SS: pitcher SP: adjusted, threw (compound)
29. CS: The mayor and the council CP: approved the budget SS: mayor, council (compound) SP: approved
30. CS: A small, determined terrier CP: chased the mail truck SS: terrier SP: chased
31. CS: a faded photograph CP: Inside the envelope was SS: photograph SP: was (inverted order)
32. CS: The retired teacher CP: volunteers at the library SS: teacher SP: volunteers
33. CS: Nadia CP: washed the dishes and swept the porch SS: Nadia SP: washed, swept (compound)
34. CS: The rows of folding chairs CP: filled the gym SS: rows SP: filled
35. CS: My uncle's two acres of vineyard CP: need pruning SS: acres SP: need

Part C: Subject–Verb Agreement

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|--------------|-----------|
| 36. was | 44. open |
| 37. needs | 45. mark |
| 38. ride | 46. has |
| 39. wants | 47. seems |
| 40. were | 48. go |
| 41. confuses | 49. was |
| 42. sits | 50. build |
| 43. call | |

Notes: 36, 42, 45, and 49 turn on the true subject (*bouquet, bundle, stains, half* = half of the cake), not the noun nearest the verb. In 39 and 44, “neither/nor” and “either/or” agree with the *nearer* subject (*teacher, clerks*). In 40 and 48 the subject follows the verb (*messages, ferries*). In 41, *mathematics* looks plural but names one subject. In 47, *twenty minutes* is a single span of time, so it takes a singular verb.

Rewrites:

51. The crate of oranges **was** left outside.
52. Neither Owen nor his brothers **play** the piano.
53. There **are** four bicycles in the rack.
54. Each of the volunteers **wears** a badge.
55. The photographs stored in the box **were** damaged.